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Postal Manual Vol II

DISCLAIMER: *This booklet has been prepared strictly from an examination point of view. While every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and the inclusion of recent changes, amendments, and updates to the relevant Acts, Rules, and Regulations, this document is intended as a study aid only. Readers and students are strongly recommended to refer to official government sources or gazettes for the most reliable and authoritative information.*

Postal Manual Vol II

Chapter 1: Organization

1. Organizational Structure

The Department of Posts operates under the Ministry of Communications. The administrative and operational hierarchy is structured as follows:

- **Minister of Communications**
- **Minister of State for Communications**
- **Secretary (Posts) / Chairman, Postal Services Board:** Responsible for policy formulation.
- **Director General Postal Services:** Responsible for operations.

Postal Services Board

The Board assists the Secretary (Posts) and comprises the following Members:

- Member (Personnel)
- Member (Operations)
- Member (Technology)
- Member (Financial Services)
- Member (HRD) - *Human Resource Development*
- Member (PLI) - *Postal Life Insurance* (Headed by CGM)
- Member (Planning & Marketing)

2. Administrative Jurisdictions (Circles)

The Department is divided into **23 Postal Circles**, each headed by a **Chief Postmaster General (CPMG)**.

S.No.	Circle	Headquarters	Jurisdiction / Coverage
1	Andhra Pradesh	Vijayawada	Andhra Pradesh
2	Assam	Guwahati	Assam
3	Bihar	Patna	Bihar
4	Chhattisgarh	Raipur	Chhattisgarh
5	Delhi	New Delhi	Delhi
6	Gujarat	Ahmedabad	Gujarat + Daman & Diu + Dadra & Nagar Haveli
7	Haryana	Ambala	Haryana
8	Himachal Pradesh	Shimla	Himachal Pradesh
9	J & K	Srinagar	Jammu & Kashmir
10	Jharkhand	Ranchi	Jharkhand
11	Karnataka	Bangalore	Karnataka
12	Kerala	Thiruvananthapuram	Kerala + Lakshadweep
13	Madhya Pradesh	Bhopal	Madhya Pradesh
14	Maharashtra	Mumbai	Maharashtra + Goa
15	North East	Shillong	Arunachal Pradesh, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Tripura
16	Odisha	Bhubaneswar	Odisha
17	Punjab	Chandigarh	Punjab + Chandigarh
18	Rajasthan	Jaipur	Rajasthan
19	Tamil Nadu	Chennai	Tamil Nadu + Pondicherry

20	Telangana	Hyderabad	Telangana
21	Uttar Pradesh	Lucknow	Uttar Pradesh
22	Uttarakhand	Dehradun	Uttarakhand
23	West Bengal	Kolkata	West Bengal + Sikkim + Andaman & Nicobar Islands

Note: The Base Circle (Army Postal Service) is headed by an Additional Director General (Major General rank), comprising **75% Civil** and **25% Armed** personnel.

3. Key Administrative Units

Regional Postal Store Depots (RPSD)

- Aligarh (Uttar Pradesh)
- Nashik (Maharashtra)
- Bhubaneswar (Odisha)
- Thrissur (Kerala)
- Kolkata (West Bengal)

Security Printing Presses

- Nashik
- Hyderabad

Zonal Returned Letter Offices (RLO)

- **Eastern:** Kolkata
- **Western:** Mumbai
- **Northern:** Lucknow
- **Southern:** Chennai

Postal Training Centres (PTC)

- **RAKNPA (Rafi Ahmed Kidwai National Postal Academy):** Ghaziabad (201 002)
- **Guwahati:** 781 001
- **Vadodara:** 390 001
- **Mysore:** 570 010
- **Madurai:** 625 022
- **Saharanpur:** 247 002
- **Darbhanga:** 846 005

Chapter 3: Appeals and Petitions

Rule 115. Classification of Representations

Any representation that is not technically an appeal shall be designated as a **petition**. A petition, if not made against a decision on a previous communication, must be addressed to the authority competent to pass orders on the subject matter and submitted through the proper channel.

Rule 116. Submission of Petitions

- **Individual Submission:** Every employee must submit a petition separately. Joint petitions are **inadmissible**.
- **Identical Petitions:** Identical petitions by multiple employees are permitted **only if** the circumstances and conditions represented apply personally to each individual submitting them.
- **Content & Language:** Petitions must be clear, concise, respectful, and free of irrelevant matter. They must end with a specific prayer.

Rule 117. Hierarchy for Submission

A petition to a higher authority against a lower authority's decision must be accompanied by a copy of the order being appealed. It must be submitted **through the officer who passed the order**.

Hierarchy of Submission:

1. **Order by Inspector:** Petition submits to **Superintendent of Post Offices** (via Inspector).
2. **Order by Superintendent:** Petition submits to **Director of Postal Services (DPS)** (via Superintendent).
3. **Order by DPS:** Petition submits to **Head of Circle** (Major Circles) or **Director General (DG)** (Minor Circles).
4. **Order by Head of Circle:** Petition submits to **Director General** (via Head of Circle).

Disciplinary Cases: For cases under **CCS (CCA) Rules, 1965**, petitions after the appellate stage are addressed to the Head of Circle or Member (Personnel). Review petitions under **Rule 29-A** are submitted to the President.

Rule 118. Disposal and Transmission

- **Direct Submission:** Petitions sent directly to higher authorities (bypassing the proper channel) will be filed without notice.
- **Forwarding Procedure:** The receiving officer must forward the petition to the addressed authority with a full statement of the case, relevant documents, and a **definite recommendation**.
- **Translation:** If the petition is in a regional language, an English translation must be appended.
- **Competency:** No petition lies to a higher authority unless the next lower competent authority has already been addressed. For example, a petition against

an Inspector's order cannot go to the DPS without first addressing the Superintendent.

Rule 118-D. Limitation Period

Petitions against orders of a lower authority are liable to be rejected without investigation if submitted more than **6 months** after the date the petitioner was informed of the order.

Rule 120. Withholding of Petitions

The Head of Circle (or authority subordinate to DG) has discretionary power to **withhold** petitions to the Director General in specific cases. The petitioner must be informed of the withholding and the reasons.

Grounds for Withholding:

1. **Transfers:** Petitions regarding transfers ordered in the interest of service, unless the officer is transferred frequently at short intervals.
2. **Unfitness for Permanent Employment:** Removal of probationers, temporary officials, or learners for being unfit (excluding specific offenses like fraud).
3. **Resignation:** Cases of voluntary unconditional resignation.
4. **Improper Language:** If the petition is illegible, unintelligible, disrespectful, or improper.
5. **Repetitive:** If a previous petition was disposed of and the fresh one discloses no new facts.
6. **Premature:** If the lower competent authority (e.g., Head of Circle) has not yet been approached for redress.
7. **Time Barred:** If submitted after **6 months** without reasonable cause for delay.
 - *Calculation of Time:* The **6 months** count from the date of the *original* order, not subsequent orders on reconsideration.

8. **Employment/Exemption:** Applications for employment not based on rules, or requests for exemption from qualification rules.
9. **Termination (Temporary Service):** Petitions against termination under **Rule 5 of CCS (Temporary Service) Rules, 1965** if submitted after **3 months**.

Rule 121. Report of Withheld Petitions

A list of petitions withheld under Rule 120 must be forwarded quarterly to the Director General.

Rule 122. Petitions to the President

Petitions addressed to the President must be forwarded to the Director General by the Head of Circle with a concise statement of facts and an expression of opinion. Petitions addressed to the "Chairman" or "Member" of the Postal Services Board are **not** treated as petitions to the President or DG and should be returned for correction.

Chapter 4: Personal Matters

Rule 127. Legal Advice and Civil Suits

In important cases at or near **Kolkata, Chennai, Mumbai**, or other stations with a Government Solicitor or Law Officer, their advice must be obtained.

Institution of Suits:

The Head of Circle must obtain the orders of the Director General before:

1. Instituting a civil suit on behalf of the Department.
2. Receiving notice that a suit is to be brought against the Department.

Exceptions (Delegated Powers):

Heads of Circles need not submit reports to the DG in the following cases:

- **Security Bonds:** Suits connected with the security bonds of postal servants.

- **Transaction Losses:** Suits regarding Money Orders, Savings Bank transactions, and insured articles, provided the amount involved does not exceed the limit prescribed.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** The monetary limits mentioned in the original text (e.g., Rs. 500 or Rs. 250) are historical. Current financial powers for instituting/defending suits are governed by the **Schedule of Financial Powers (Schedule II)** and the **Delegation of Financial Powers Rules (DFPR)**, which authorize significantly higher limits for Heads of Circles.

Recoveries from Guarantors:

Heads of Circles may authorize civil suits against defaulting guarantors of combined offices to recover deficits, provided:

- There is a reasonable prospect of realization.
- The action is advised by the local Government Solicitor.

Rule 127-A. Signing of Plaints

All **Gazetted Officers** in the Department who are fully conversant with the facts of a case are authorized to:

- Sign and verify **Plaints and Written Statements** in civil suits by or against the Central Government.
- Sign **Vakalatnamas** on behalf of the Central Government.

Rule 133. Institution of Criminal Proceedings

- **Non-Cognizable Cases:** Prosecution must **not** be instituted without the previous sanction of the Head of the Circle.
- **Emergency Exception:** If delay would allow the accused to escape, sanction may be anticipated, but the action must be reported immediately by email/post to the Head of Circle.

Rule 135. Conduct of Prosecutions

Upon receiving orders to prosecute in a non-cognizable case, the officer must prefer a written complaint to the nearest empowered Magistrate.

Rule 138. framing of Charges

- **Three Charges Rule:** An accused person can be tried at one trial for only **three charges** of the same kind.
- **Timeframe:** These three offenses must have been committed within a period of **12 months** from the first to the last.

Rule 146. Employment of Government Pleader

- **Scope:** The Government Pleader generally represents the Government in criminal appeals and Sessions cases, but not in ordinary cases before Magistrates.
- **Fees:** If the Pleader is not obliged to appear without a special fee, their services requires the sanction of the Head of Circle.
- **Ordinary Cases:** Ordinarily, no legal assistance should be required for conducting cases before a Magistrate.

Rule 152. Exemption from Jury Service

All persons employed in the Department of Posts are **exempt** from liability to serve as Jurors or Assessors in courts.

Rule 174-A. Funeral Expenses

Funeral expenses incidental to the death of departmental employees in departmental premises or on duty at out-stations (where bodies cannot be attended to by relatives) should be debited to the **Contingent Grant** of the office concerned.

Chapter 5: Security Deposits

Rule 191. Officials Required to Furnish Security

Due to pecuniary responsibilities, the following classes of officials must provide security:

(i) Circle & Administrative Offices:

- Cashiers.
- Managers/Assistant Managers and Assistants in Returned Letter Offices (RLO).
- Group D Staff in Circle Offices/Postal Store Depots handling cash or valuable stock.
- Record Suppliers/Daftries in Store Depots (e.g., Aligarh).

(ii) Post Offices & R.M.S.:

- Departmental Sub-Postmasters (Classes A, B, & C).
- Treasurers and Assistant Treasurers.
- Cashiers in S.R.O. / H.R.O.
- Sorting Assistants and Mail Guards.
- Head Postmen, Cash Overseers, and officials escorting cash.
- Mail Peons, Van Peons, Packers, and Runners handling cash.

Note on Amounts:

- **Cash/Savings/Govt Notes:** If security is given in these forms, the amount required is **two-thirds** of the standard security amount.
- **Stamp Vendors:** Security shall be **20 times** the vendor's pay, subject to the maximum fixed by the Department.

Rule 192. Exemptions

The following may be exempted from furnishing security:

1. **High Pay/Long Service:** Officials drawing pay above a fixed limit or having **20 years' service** (at the discretion of the Divisional Head).
2. **Pensioners:** Retired Government servants re-employed as GDS Branch Postmasters, Postmen, etc., provided they are in receipt of a pension.

Rule 194. Forms of Security

Security must be furnished in one of the following forms:

1. **Cash** (Deposited in POSB).
2. **Government Promissory Notes** or Post Office Certificates (POSC).
3. **Personal Bond** with two sureties.

Restriction: Acting Postmen and Village Postmen must *always* furnish security in the form of a **Personal Bond**.

Rule 211. Execution of Bonds

For personal bonds, the witness attesting the signature must be an official **above the rank of Postman**.

Rule 218. Verification of Securities

- **Frequency:** Officers holding custody of bonds must verify the existence and solvency of sureties **annually**.
- **Scale of Verification:**
 - If total bonds < 40: Verify **at least one**.
 - If total bonds > 40: Verify **one bond for every 40** (or fraction thereof).

- **Fresh Security:** If a surety dies, becomes insolvent, or withdraws, the principal (if they have less than 10 years' service) must furnish fresh security.

Rule 222. Refund of Security

Deposits (Cash/Notes/Certificates) must not be refunded until **six months** have elapsed from:

- The date of death/insolvency, OR
- The date of notice of withdrawal, OR
- The date of leaving service.

Rule 225. Pledging of Security

- **Gazetted Officers:** Pledge security to the **Appointing Authority**.
- **Non-Gazetted Officers:** Pledge security to the **Immediate Superior** (who must be of Gazetted status).

Rule 227. Custody of Passbooks

Security Deposit Passbooks must be kept by the Head of Office, locked in a **tin box** along with the relevant bonds. The account number must be entered in the Register of Bonds (Form Sec. 19).

Rule 240. Alteration of Form

An official may replace a Personal Bond with a Cash/Government Security deposit at any time. The new deposit must be at least **two-thirds** of the standard security amount. Installment deductions (if applicable) must be at least **one-sixth** of the employee's pay.

Rule 247. Retention and Destruction of Bonds

- **Preservation Period:** Expired or replaced bonds must be preserved for **5 years**.

- **After 5 Years:** Cases involving officials who quit service should be reviewed to see if retention is needed (limitation for breach is **30 years**).
- **Promotion:** Bonds of officials promoted to Inspector/Supervisor roles should be preserved for **one year** after confirmation.

Rule 249. Inadmissible Sureties

- **Professional Money-Lenders:** Strictly prohibited.
- **Soldiers:** Not accepted as sureties.
- **Ladies:** Not advisable unless single or widows, and only if no male surety is available.

Rule 250. Time Limits for Furnishing Security

- **Temporary Post Candidate:** Within **one month**.
- **Permanent Post Candidate:** Within **three months**.
- **Extension:** The Head of Division (HOD) may extend these periods to **three months** (temporary) and **six months** (permanent).

Rule 260. Unclaimed Deposits

Security deposits remaining unclaimed for **three years** after becoming refundable are credited to Government under "**Miscellaneous Revenue**".

Chapter 6: Stock Management

Rule 269-B. Classification of Stock

Stock is classified into two primary categories:

1. **Dead Stock:** Plant, machinery, furniture, and fixtures.
2. **Stores:** Consumable and perishable articles.

Inventory Maintenance:

Inventories for both Dead Stock and Stores must be maintained in the Stock Book (Form S.K.-1)2.

Rule 270. Locks and Keys

Strict protocols govern the custody and repair of locks to ensure security.

- **Repairs:** Locks that are damaged or unserviceable **must not be repaired locally**. They must be returned to the Depot.
- **Keys:** Only **one key** is supplied with each lock.
 - **Lost Keys:** If a key is lost, the lock must be broken open and sent to the Depot for replacement. The cost is recovered from the official at fault.
 - **Duplicate Keys:** Manufacturing or procuring duplicate keys locally is **strictly prohibited**.
- **Safe Keys:** Safes purchased from private manufacturers are supplied with one key; the duplicate is retained in the Depot.
- **Steel Almirahs/Cabinets:** For storage units supplied with manufacturer-provided duplicate keys, the duplicates are kept in the **Divisional Office**.

Rule 271. Custody of Duplicate Keys

- **Divisional Office Custody:** Duplicate keys for steel almirahs/cabinets (except those of the Head of Office) are kept in the Divisional Office in the **joint custody** of the Office Supervisor/ASPOs (HQ) and the Stock Assistant.
- **Head of Office Keys:** The duplicate key of the Head of Office's almirah must be sealed in an envelope with their personal seal and sent to the Circle Office for safe custody.

- **Retrieval:** If an original key is lost, the issuance of the duplicate must be authorized by the Divisional Officer. The duplicate is sent via **Insured Registered Parcel** (insured for Rs. 100).

Rule 272-275. Stock Registers

- **General Stock Book:** Maintained in **Form S.K.-1** in every office.
- **Stock Register of Bags:** Maintained in **Form S.K.-1(a)** for offices authorized by the Head of Circle.
- **Forms Register:** A stock register for all varieties of forms is maintained in **Form S.K.-1(b)**.

Rule 277. Emergent Indents

- **Purpose:** For urgent requirements of articles.
- **Frequency:** Prepared as needed, but ordinarily **not more than once a month**.
- **Submission:** Submitted in **triplicate** using Form S.K.-2 or Genl.-18.

Rule 286-288. Supply of Forms

- **Schedule:** The Head of Circle prescribes two six-monthly periods for supply.
- **Master Schedule:** Shows the description, average rate of consumption, and total quantity required for six months.
- **Wastage Margin:** The total requirement includes a margin for wastage:
 - 2% for forms used departmentally.
 - 10% for forms used by the public.
 - (Up to 15% allowed for selected big offices for public forms) .
- **Review:** The Master Schedule is reviewed every **5 years**.

Chapter 7: Stationery

Rule 341-A. Fixed Stationery Charges

Fixed stationery charges are allocated to offices and staff for the procurement of essential items like sealing wax, twine, and glue.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** The specific monetary rates listed in older manuals (e.g., Rs. 5 or Rs. 25) are historical and have been superseded. Current rates are prescribed periodically by the Postal Directorate/Ministry of Finance. The items eligible for charges include:

- Cost of closing and sealing bags.
- Cost of candles and sealing wax.
- Cost of twine/rubber bands for bundles.
- Stationery charges for clerical staff, Mail Overseers, and Mail Peons.

Rule 366-371. Indents and Registers

- **Register:** Maintained in **Form S.K.-8**.
- **Guard Books:** Indented for **once in three years**.

Chapter 9: Contracts

Rule 420. Responsibilities

- **Officer Responsibility:** Employing a contractor does not relieve the officer in charge of responsibility for the work's quality or timeliness.
- **Power to Act:** Contracts must grant the officer full power to intervene if the contractor delays or fails to perform satisfactorily.
- **Monitoring:** A **Register of Contracts** must be maintained in Circle, Divisional, and 1st Class Head Offices. It should be reviewed **monthly** to identify contracts expiring within the next **12 months**.

Rule 427. Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)

- **Requirement:** Tenders must be accompanied by Earnest Money (Bid Security) ranging from **2% to 5%** of the estimated value of goods.
- **Exemptions:** No EMD is required from:
 - Firms registered with DGS&D (now GeM).
 - Small Scale Industries (SSI) / MSME units.
 - Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs).

Rule 430. Performance Security

Security deposits are demanded to ensure the performance of contracts.

- **Quantum:** The security deposit amount is decided by the Head of Department.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** While the source text mentions a limit of 3-5%, **Rule 171 of the General Financial Rules (GFR) 2017** prescribes that Performance Security should be **5% to 10%** of the value of the contract.

Rule 431. Forms of Contract

- **M-50:** Conveyance of mails by wheeled carriages (animal-drawn).
- **M-50(a):** Conveyance of mails by motor vehicles in rural areas.
- **M-50(b):** Conveyance by mazdoors, pack mules, or ponies.
- **M-51:** Revised agreement for conveyance by motor vehicles.

Chapter 10: Land and Buildings

Rule 449. Hiring of Buildings

- **Tender:** When it is necessary to hire a building, a tender should be called for in **Form Genl-22**.

- **Lease Deed:** The lease for the rented building should be drawn up in **Form Genl-8**.

Rule 450. Ownership of Buildings

- **Vesting Date:** The ownership of all Government buildings occupied by the Department on **1st April 1921** vests in the Department, even if originally constructed out of State Revenues.
- **Military Buildings:** Ownership of buildings owned by the Military Department does not vest in the Postal Department, even if occupied by the latter on the vesting date.

Rule 457. Sale of Land and Buildings

- **Method:** Land belonging to the Department should ordinarily be sold through the Revenue Department.
- **Authority:** Permanent departmental buildings and land may be sold under the sanction of the Head of Circle, provided the value does not exceed Rs. 1 Lakh.

Rule 465. Transfer of Assets Between Departments

Specific valuation rules apply when transferring land and buildings between Central Government departments:

1. Commercial Departments (excluding Railways):

- **No Book Value:** No charge is made.
- **Valued in Books:** Charge is **Book Value** or **Market Value**, whichever is less.

2. Ministry of Defence:

- **No Book Value:** Charge is **half market value**.
- **Valued in Books:** Charge is Book Value or Market Value (whichever is less), subject to a **minimum of half market value**.

3. Railway Department:

- **Charge:** The **full market value** is charged in each case.

Rule 499. Project Estimates

Proposals for including original works in the building schedule must be submitted in the **Project Estimate Form (Eng. 110)**. These must reach the Directorate by **15th October** at the latest.

Rule 502. Revision of Sanction

- **Excess up to 10%:** If expenditure exceeds the sanctioned amount by **not more than 10%**, no revised sanction is necessary.
- **Excess over 10%:** If the excess is **more than 10%**, a revised project estimate and preliminary estimate must be prepared for fresh administrative approval and expenditure sanction.

Rule 529. Rent for RMS Buildings (Railway Premises)

Rent for RMS buildings on Railway land is calculated on the following basis:

(a) Interest Charges:

- Capital invested after 01.04.1964: **Dividend Rate (6%)**.
- Capital invested prior to 01.04.1964: **4.5%**.

(b) Depreciation & Maintenance (Civil Works):

- **Depreciation:** **2%** of original building cost (excluding land).
- **Maintenance:** **2.4%** of original cost (excluding land).
- *(Total for Non-residential: 4.4%)*
- **Residential Buildings:** **3.9%** (Maintenance) + Depreciation.

(c) Electrical Installations:

- Depreciation & Maintenance: 8% of the original cost.

Rule 539. Nominal Rents for Welfare

- **Departmental Bodies:** Accommodation provided for canteens, grain shops, or co-operative societies run departmentally is charged a nominal rent of **Re. 1 per month**. No municipal taxes or electric/water rent is levied.
- **Recreation Clubs:** Vacant plots used for tennis courts/games by Postal Recreation Clubs are charged a nominal rent of Re. 1 per annum.

Rule 559. Staff Amenities Scales

- **Tiffin Rooms:** Provided for offices with a staff of **4 or more clerks**.
- **Rest Rooms:** Provided in delivery offices with a minimum strength of **10 delivery staff** per shift.
 - *Scale:* Minimum **120 sq. ft.**, plus **12 sq. ft.** for every additional person.

Chapter 11: Miscellaneous Rules**National Observances & Protocol**

- **National Week:** Celebrated from **6th to 13th April**.
- **Flag Display:** The National Flag must be on the **extreme right** (observer's left) when displayed in a straight line with other countries' flags. It is hoisted first and lowered last.
- **Anthems:**
 - Beginning of function: "**Vande Mataram**".
 - End of function: "**Jana Gana Mana**".

Rule 616. Use of Ink

Except where specifically prescribed, ink other than **blue** should not be used on official correspondence or records.

Rule 637. Filing System (Superintendent of Post Offices)

Correspondence files in the Divisional Office are classified under standard heads:

File Head	Class of Correspondence
A	Establishment (Creation/Revision), Opening/Closing of offices/lines.
B	Personal Matters (Appointments, Transfers, Leave, Punishments, Service Books).
C	Pensions and Gratuities.
D	Buildings and Runners' Huts.
E	Accounts, TA, Audit References.
F	Robberies, Losses, Frauds.
G	Mails (Due lists, Notices, Business Hours).
H	Experimental Establishments.
I	Monsoon Arrangements.
J	Indents, Contingent Expenditure.
K	Annual Report Info.
L	Petty Irregularities / Miscellaneous.

Rule 637. Filing System (Superintendent of Railway Mail Service)

Correspondence files in the Office of a Superintendent of Railway Mail Service (RMS) are classified under standard heads.

File Head	Class of Correspondence
A	Procedure: General orders, rules regarding mails, unregistered articles, station bundles (paid/unpaid), and registered articles/bundles.
B	Personal: Appointments, leave, punishments, pensions, gratuities, security bonds, service books, character sheets, and gradation lists.

C	Establishment: Creation/revision/abolition of establishments, proposition statements, and distribution lists.
D	Sorting: Sorting lists (supply/printing), due bag statements, sorting mail offices, transit sections, and special orders (e.g., town delivery bags).
E	Distribution of Work: Arrangement of work in offices/vans/sections, changes in jurisdiction/beats, and opening/closing of sections.
F	Accommodation: Mail vans and buildings (construction, repair, references).
G	Conveyance of Mails: Opening of new lines, time-tables, train detention/misconnection, accidents, and mail steamer notices.
H	Stock: General stock rules, stationery rate list, supply of bags/forms, uniforms, and indents.
J	Accounts: General accounts, permanent advances (contingencies/stamps), fixed contingent allowances, and audit references.
K	Investigations: Robberies, losses, frauds, and serious irregularities.
M	Camp Articles: Movement of high officers and disposal of camp articles.
Z	Miscellaneous: Minor irregularities (bags, bundles) and matters not included elsewhere.

Rule 666. Service Postage

- **Personal Communication:** No personal communication from a departmental official may be sent free "On Service".
- **Penalty:** Breach of this rule attracts a penalty of **double the charges** that should have been paid, recovered via postage stamps.

Rule 666. Handling of Personal Files & Leave Papers

- **Transfer of Officials:** When an official is transferred or deputed for a period exceeding **3 months** to another Circle, Division, or Office, their personal file/bundle must be forwarded in a **Service Registered Cover**.

- **Casual Leave Papers:** Papers relating to casual leave should **not** be made part of the permanent personal file. At the end of each year, all casual leave papers should be **destroyed** and a fresh series started.

Rule 694-C. Postal Circle Maps

A Skeleton Postal Map of the Circle must be submitted to the Director General (DG) in the month of **June** each year. It must incorporate all corrections necessitated by changes during the past year to keep the DG's records up to date.

Rule 708. Alphabetical List of Post Offices

The Alphabetical List of Post Offices and the Postal Guide are published annually:

- **Main Edition:** Published in the month of **September**.
- **Supplementary:** Published in **April** of the following year.

Rule 696. Annual Reports

- **To Head of Circle:** Must be submitted by **1st May**.
- **To Director General:** Must be submitted before **16th June**.

Rule 721. Identity Cards

The normal life of the Departmental Identity Card (**Form Ms-95**) is **4 years**.

Budget Estimate and Control

Budget Structure

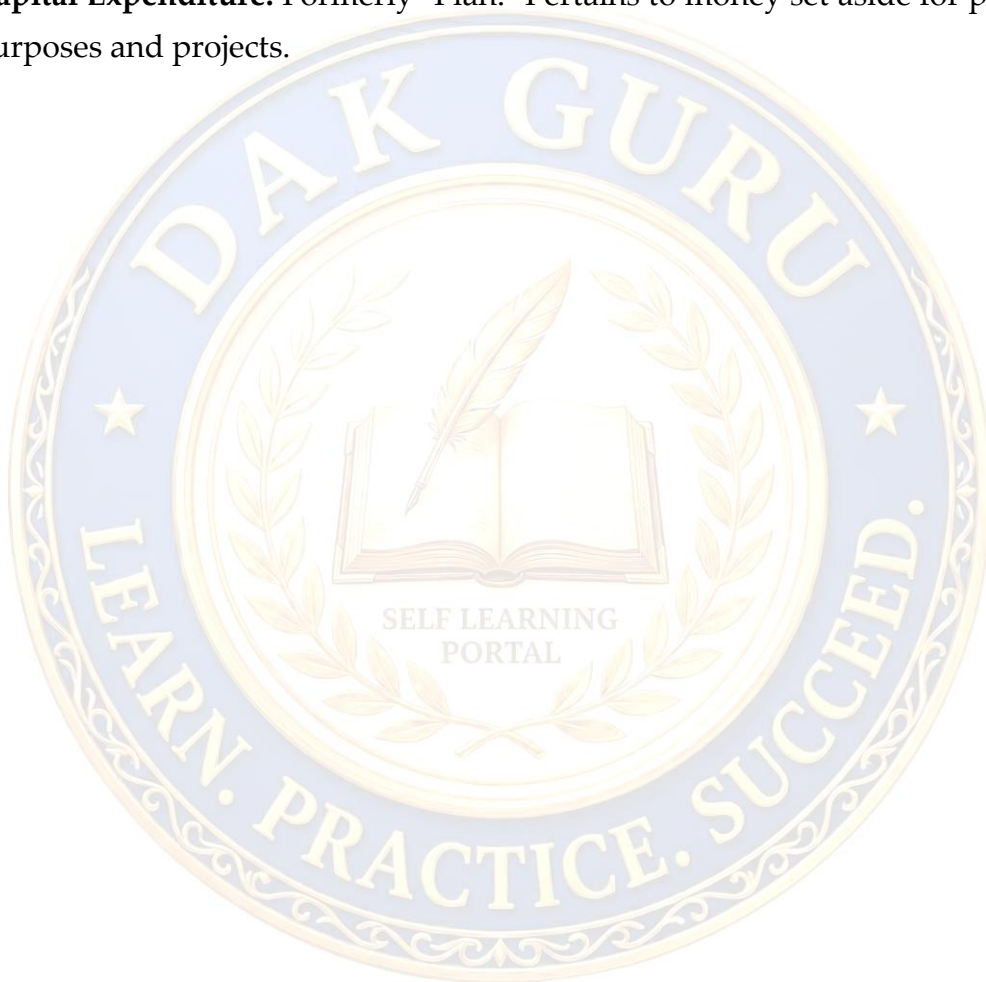
The Secretary (Department of Posts) acts as the **Chief Accounts Authority**. The Budget Cell in each Circle is headed by the Chief Postmaster General and comprises two units:

1. **Budget Control Unit (BCU):** Located at the **Postal Accounts Office (PAO)**.
2. **Budget Operation Unit (BOU):** Located at the **Circle Office (CO)**.

Rule 756-A. Expenditure Classification

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** The distinction between "Plan" and "Non-Plan" expenditure was **phased out** from the Budget of **2017-18** onwards.

- **Revenue Expenditure:** Formerly "Non-Plan." Covers non-productive areas like salaries, subsidies, and interest.
- **Capital Expenditure:** Formerly "Plan." Pertains to money set aside for productive purposes and projects.



Postal Manual Volume II (Supplementary Data)

1. Deadlines for Stationery Indents (Rule 371)

The submission dates for stationery indents are fixed based on the half-year period.

Indent Ending	Period	Submit to Supdt by	Submit to Store Depot by
30th September		10th February	25th February
31st March		10th August	25th August

Note: Guard Books should be indented for **once in three years**.

2. Specific Forms & Registers (Missed Items)

- **Form Corr-22:** Used for **unimportant** correspondence (with carbon paper).
- **Form Corr-40:** Used for **important** correspondence.
- **Form S.K.-3 (Return):** Used as an invoice when **returning** articles to the Depot (prepared in triplicate).
- **Form Genl-8A:** Lease deed executed when non-residential departmental accommodation is let out to a **private person**.

3. Jurisdiction of Regional Forms Depots (Rule 292)

Specific Depots serve specific Circles:

- **Aligarh:** Delhi, J&K, Ambala (Haryana), Ludhiana (Punjab), Jaipur (Rajasthan), Lucknow (UP), Dehradun (Uttarakhand), Shimla (HP).
- **Nashik:** Ahmedabad (Gujarat), Bangalore (Karnataka), Mumbai (Maharashtra), Nagpur, Bhopal (MP), Raipur (Chhattisgarh).
- **Bhubaneswar:** Hyderabad (Telangana), Vijayawada (AP), Patna (Bihar), Bhubaneswar (Odisha), Ranchi (Jharkhand).
- **Thrissur:** Kochi, Chennai (Tamil Nadu), Madurai.

- **Kolkata:** Kolkata (WB), Guwahati (Assam/NE), Silchar.

4. Land & Building Rules (Specifics)

- **Boundary Verification (Rule 460):** Boundaries of departmental land must be verified by an officer **not below the rank of Divisional Officer**.
- **Residential Excess (Rule 538-C):** Superintendents and 1st Class Postmasters can sanction the "condonation" of excess residential accommodation up to **100 sq. ft.** if it cannot be utilized otherwise.
- **Private Tenants (Rule 588):** When renting to private persons:
 - Rent is collected **monthly in advance**.
 - **6 months' rent** must be deposited as security.
 - Rent charged is **Standard Rent (FR 45-B)** or **Market Rent**, whichever is **higher**.
- **Fire Extinguishers (Rule 580):** These are **not stock items**. They are purchased against rate/running contracts (GeM/DGS&D).

5. Miscellaneous Rules

- **IPC Section 409 (Rule 394):** An official who removes marks/cancellations from service stamps to reuse them is liable for **Criminal Breach of Trust** under **Section 409 of the Indian Penal Code**.
- **Contract Copies (Rule 420/2):** Copies of contracts exceeding Rs. 50,000 must be furnished to the Audit Office for scrutiny.
- **Salutation (Rule 619):** In communication with officers of the Department, the subscription "**Yours faithfully**" should be used.